



THREAT ADVISORY

**ATTACK
REPORT**

SparklingGoblin Revamps SideWalk Backdoor for Linux Variant

Date of Publication

September 16, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

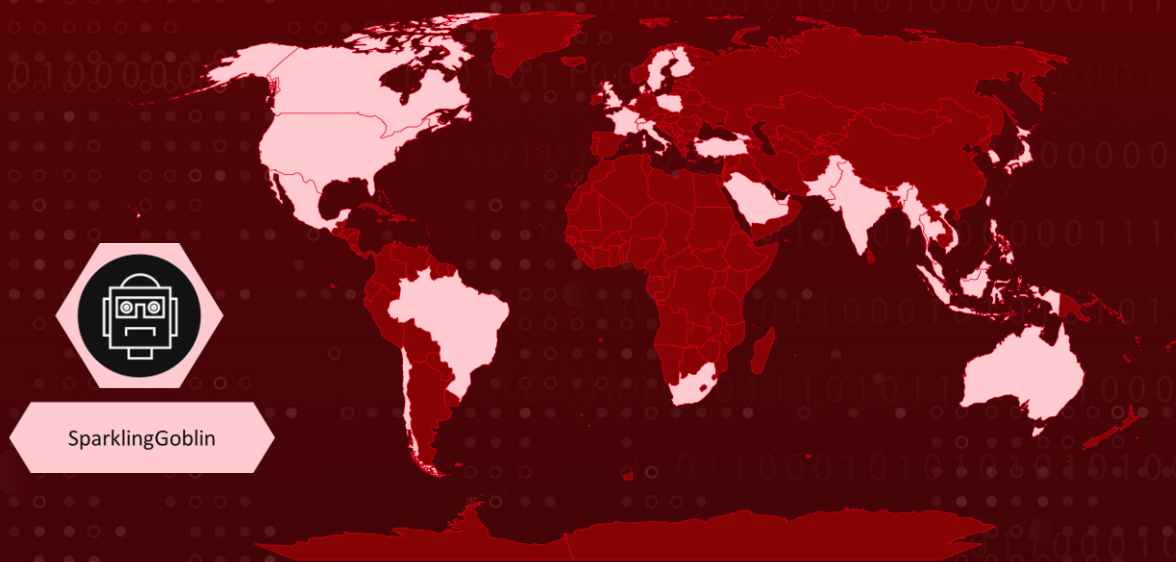
TA Number

TA2022205

Summary

SparklingGoblin aka Earth Baku State-backed Chinese hackers has integrated a Linux variant of the SideWalk backdoor. SparklingGoblin Threat actors typically target East and Southeast Asian countries, with a special emphasis on the educational sector, employing Motnug and ChaCha20-based loaders, the CROSSWALK and SideWalk backdoors, as well as Korplug (aka PlugX) and Cobalt Strike.

Actor Map



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Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

TA0042 Resource Development	T1587 Develop Capabilities	T1587.001 Malware	TA0007 Discovery
T1016 System Network Configuration Discovery	TA0011 Command and Control	T1071 Application Layer Protocol	T1071.001 Web Protocols
T1573 Encrypted Channel	T1573.001 Symmetric Cryptography		

Technical Details

#1

SideWalk is a multifunctional backdoor that can load other modules from the command-and-control server. It employs Google Docs as a dead-drop resolver and Cloudflare workers as its command and control (C2) server. The malware runs five threads simultaneously in order to complete a single task.

#2

The Linux variant includes symbols and leaves some unique authentication keys and other artifacts unprotected, making discovery and analysis considerably more convenient. This Linux version shares many similarities with its Windows counterpart while also introducing some new features.



Actor Detail

NAME	ORIGIN	TARGET LOCATIONS	TARGET INDUSTRIES
SparklingGoblin (APT 41, Double Dragon, TG-2633 , Bronze Atlas, Red Kelpie, Blackfly, Earth Baku, Grayfly)	China	Australia, Bahrain, Brazil, Canada, Chile, Denmark, Finland, France, Georgia, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, Mexico, Myanmar, Netherlands, Pakistan, Philippines, Poland, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, South Korea, South Africa, Sweden, Switzerland, Taiwan, Thailand, Turkey, UAE, UK, USA, Vietnam.	Construction, Defense, Education, Energy, Financial, Government, Healthcare, High-Tech, Hospitality, Manufacturing, Media, Oil and gas, Petrochemical, Pharmaceutical, Retail, Telecommunications, Transportation, gaming.
	MOTIVE		
	Financial crime, Information theft and espionage		

✂ Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA1	fa6a40d3fc5cd4d975a01e298179a0b36aa02d4e7df0be2774b17f672b96860d013a933e97862e6c
IPV4	172[.]67[.]8[.]5966[.]42[.]103[.]222
Domain	rec.microsoft[.]ga

✂ References

<https://www.welivesecurity.com/2022/09/14/you-never-walk-alone-sidewalk-backdoor-linux-variant/>

What Next?

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